

Kannada, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they
are written.

Companion practice lessons live alongside this book at
code/learning/human-languages/kannada/lessons/

Copyright © Adhithya Rajasekaran. Licensed under Creative Commons
Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (CC BY-SA 4.0). Kannada set in
Noto Sans Kannada (SIL Open Font License).

Preface

This is the Kannada volume of a wider project, and it is written for someone starting from zero — who may not read a single Kannada letter — so the script is taught *inside the word lessons themselves*: each word introduces exactly the letters it needs, so you learn to read ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ *and* learn that it means “greetings” in the same few minutes. There is no alphabet drill to sit through first. (A reader who already reads Kannada simply skims the “letters in this word” notes.)

Kannada is one of the four literary **Dravidian** languages — a family entirely separate from the Indo-European one that gave us English, Latin, and Sanskrit. Its own personality shows in one contrast, drawn again and again in these pages: where its oldest sister **Tamil** guards its native word-stock, Kannada borrowed *freely* from Sanskrit. So “hello” is the Sanskrit ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (*namaskāra*) — yet “no” and “okay” are the native Dravidian ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*) and ಸರಿ (*sari*), shared almost unchanged with Tamil. Each lesson sets the word beside its cousins across the family — English always, and Sanskrit, Hindi, and the other Dravidian languages where they illuminate — every form supplied in full, so no prior knowledge of any of them is assumed.

Same three commitments as the other volumes: one word per lesson, gone deep; the widest *honest* web of connections; the cultural reason, not just the rule. Released under CC BY-SA 4.0.

Contents

Preface	iii
The Kannada script (reference)	1
1 Greetings	3
1.1 ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (namaskāra) — “greetings,” a making of a bow . . .	3
1.2 ಧನ್ಯವಾದ (dhan̄yavāda) — “thank you,” an utterance of “worthy”	4
1.3 ಹೌದು (haudu) — “yes”	5
1.4 ಇಲ್ಲ (illa) — “no,” a word Tamil shares almost exactly	6
1.5 ಸರಿ (sari) — “okay,” shared whole with Tamil	7
1.6 Recap, and how Kannada says goodbye	7
2 Introducing Yourself	9
2.1 ಹೆಸರು (hesaru) — “name,” and the <i>p</i> -to- <i>h</i> shift	9
2.2 ನನ್ನ (nanna) — “my”	10
2.3 ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ... (nanna hesaru ...) — “my name is...”	10
2.4 Familiar and respectful “you”	11
2.5 ಏನು (ēnu) — “what”	11
2.6 What’s your name?	11
2.7 ಸಂತೋಷ (santōṣa) — “joy,” and “pleased to meet you” . . .	12
2.8 The whole exchange	12
3 How Are You?	13
3.1 ಹೇಗೆ (hēge) — “how,” another of the <i>ē</i> - questions	13
3.2 ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? — “how are you?”	13
3.3 ನಾನು (nānu) — “I,” the Dravidian first person	14
3.4 ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ (cennāgi) — “well,” and how to answer	14
3.5 ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ (paravāgilla) — “no problem”	15
3.6 The whole exchange	16

4 Farewells	17
4.1 ಹೋಗು (<i>hōgu</i>) — “go,” and ಬಾ (come)	17
4.2 ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (<i>hōgi baruttēne</i>) — “I’ll go and come back” . .	17
4.3 ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ (<i>nāle sigōṇa</i>) — “see you tomorrow”	18
4.4 We’ll meet again	18
4.5 The farewells	19
5 The First Verbs	21
5.1 ಮಾತನಾಡು (<i>mātanāḍu</i>) — “to speak,” your first full verb . . .	21
5.2 ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ — “I speak Kannada”	22
5.3 ಇರು (<i>iru</i>) — “to be, to stay, to live”	22
5.4 ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು (<i>kelasa māḍu</i>) — “to work”	23
5.5 Sentences about yourself	23
6 Case Endings and Dative Subjects	25
6.1 -ge	25
6.2 -ge	26
6.3 nanage kannada gottu	28
7 Numbers One to Ten	31
7.1 ಒಂದು ಎರಡು ಮೂರು ನಾಲ್ಕು ಐದು	31
7.2 ಆರು ಏಳು ಎಂಟು ಒಂಬತ್ತು ಹತ್ತು	33
8 Please	35
8.1 ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು	35
9 Sorry	39
9.1 ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ	39
10 Days of the Week	43
10.1 ಸೋಮವಾರ ಮಂಗಳವಾರ ಬುಧವಾರ ಗುರುವಾರ ಶುಕ್ರವಾರ ಶನಿವಾರ ಭಾನುವಾರ	43
11 Four Core Colours	45
11.1 ಕಪ್ಪು ಬಿಳಿ ಕೆಂಪು ನೀಲಿ	45
12 Family	47
12.1 ಅಪ್ಪ ಅಮ್ಮ ಅಣ್ಣ ತಮ್ಮ ಅಕ್ಕ ತಂಗಿ	47
13 Head and Hand	49
13.1 ತಲೆ ಕೈ	49

14 Seasons	51
14.1 ವಸಂತ ಋತು ಬೇಸಿಗೆ ಮಳೆಗಾಲ ಚಳಿಗಾಲ	51
15 Water and Rice	53
15.1 ನೀರು ಅಕ್ಕಿ ಅನ್ನ	53
16 The Traditional Months	55
16.1 ಚೈತ್ರ ವೈಶಾಖ ಜ್ಯೇಷ್ಠ ಆಷಾಢ ಶ್ರಾವಣ ಭಾದ್ರಪದ ಆಶ್ವಯುಜ ಕಾರ್ತಿಕ ಮಾರ್ಗಶಿರ ಪುಷ್ಯ ಮಾಘ ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ	55
17 Noon and Midnight	57
17.1 ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ	57
18 Telling Time	59
18.1 ಗಂಟೆ	59
19 Asking Someone's Age	61
19.1 ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು?	61
20 Numbers 11–20 and Weather	63
20.1 ಹನ್ನೊಂದು — ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು	63
20.2 ಹವಾಮಾನ	64
21 Dog and Cat	67
21.1 ನಾಯಿ, ಬೆಕ್ಕು	67
22 Green and Yellow	69
22.1 ಹಸಿರು, ಹಳದಿ	69
23 Day	71
23.1 ದಿನ	71
24 Night	73
24.1 ರಾತ್ರಿ	73
25 Good Night	75
25.1 ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ	75
26 Morning	77
26.1 ಬೆಳಿಗ್ಗೆ	77

27 Evening	79
27.1 ಸಂಜೆ	79
28 Afternoon	81
28.1 ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ	81
29 Good Morning	83
29.1 ಶುಭೋದಯ	83
30 Good Evening	85
30.1 ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ	85
31 Good Afternoon	87
31.1 ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ	87

The Kannada script — a reference

Not to be read before the lessons — they teach reading through real words, each letter introduced as a word needs it. This page just gathers the system.

The three facts

1. **Consonants carry a built-in “a.”** ಕ = ka, ಮ = ma, ರ = ra.
2. **A vowel sign changes that built-in vowel.** ಕಾ = kā, ಕಿ = ki, ಕೀ = kī, ಕು = ku, ಕೂ = kū, ಕೆ = ke, ಕೇ = kē, ಕೊ = ko, ಕೋ = kō, ಕೌ = kau.
3. **A *virama* strips the built-in vowel, and the bare consonant *stacks under the next* as a conjunct (*ottakṣara*):** ನೆ + ಕೆ → ನ್ಕೆ (ska), ನೆ + ಯೆ → ನ್ಯೆ (nya), ಲ + ಲ → ಲ್ಲ (lla). This stacking is a signature of the Kannada–Telugu scripts.

Independent vowels (word-initial)

ಅ a · ಆ ā · ಇ i · ಈ ī · ಉ u · ಊ ū · ಎ e · ಏ ē · ಐ ai · ಒ o · ಓ
ಒ · ಔ au.

Worth flagging

- **Aspiration is written.** ಕೆ k / ಖೆ kh, ದೆ d / ಧೆ dh — the “h” is a real puff. (Unlike Tamil, Kannada keeps separate letters for the Sanskrit aspirates and voiced stops, because it borrowed so many Sanskrit words.)
- **Round forms.** Kannada letters are rounded and looping — developed for writing on palm-leaf, where straight strokes would split the leaf. Telugu, its closest script-sister, shares the look.

Kannada in the Dravidian family

Kannada is one of the four literary **Dravidian** languages (with Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam) — a family entirely separate from the Indo-European one (English, Latin, Sanskrit). It shares the grammar and much native vocabulary with its sisters, but — like Telugu, and unlike Tamil — it borrowed *heavily* from Sanskrit. The lessons trace, word by word, which Kannada words are home-grown (*haudu*, *illa*, *sari*) and which came from Sanskrit (*namaskāra*, *dhanyavāda*).

Chapter 1

Greetings

The Kannada greetings and the words that oil a first conversation — and, taught through them, how to read the Kannada script and how Kannada sits inside the Dravidian family. Each lesson introduces the letters its word needs, so you learn to read the word and understand it at once. *Practice lessons: lessons/KA-C01-*.md.*

1.1 ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (namaskāra) — “greetings,” a making of a bow

The letters in this word

Kannada reads **left to right**, and every consonant carries a built-in “a.” ನ na, ಮ ma, ರ ra. A **vowel sign** changes that vowel: ಕ ka + the long-“ā” sign → ಕಾ kā. And a vowel-less consonant **stacks under** the next as a conjunct (*ottakṣara*): ಸೆ loses its vowel and tucks under ka → ಸ್ಕ “ska.” Read ನ·ಮ·ಸ್ಕ·ಕಾ·ರ → namaskāra.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ (namaskāra) is **not** native Kannada — it is **Sanskrit**: *namas* (“a bow, homage”) + *kāra* (“a making,” from the root *kr*, “to do”) = “the making of a bow.” The very same word as Hindi *namaskār*. Where its sister Tamil kept a home-grown greeting (*vaṇakkam*), Kannada borrowed freely from Sanskrit — the theme of this whole book.

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“Hello”	Source
Kannada	ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ <i>namaskāra</i>	Sanskrit
Telugu	<i>namaskāram</i>	Sanskrit
Malayalam	<i>namaskāram</i>	Sanskrit
Hindi	<i>namaste</i>	Sanskrit
Tamil	<i>vaṇakkam</i>	native Dravidian
English	<i>hello</i>	Germanic

Tamil alone kept its own word; the rest lean on the Sanskrit *namas-*.

Why it’s said this way

Said with the palms pressed together and a small bow — the gesture *is* the word. It serves as both **hello and goodbye**, any time, to almost anyone, respectful without being stiff.

1.2 ಧನ್ಯವಾದ (*dhanyavāda*) — “thank you,” an utterance of “worthy”

The letters in this word

New: ಧ *dha* (an **aspirated** *d* — a puff of breath), and the conjunct ನ್ಯ (*na* stacked with *ya* → “*nya*”). ವಾ is *vā*. Read ಧನ್ಯವಾದ → *dhanyavāda*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಧನ್ಯವಾದ (*dhanyavāda*) is **Sanskrit**: *dhanya* (“worthy, blessed,” from *dhana*, “wealth”) + *vāda* (“a saying,” root *vad*, “to speak”) = “an utterance of ‘[you are] worthy.’” The same word as Hindi *dhanyavād* and Telugu *dhanyavādamulu*.

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“Thanks”	Note
Kannada	ಧನ್ಯವಾದ <i>dhanyavāda</i>	Sanskrit
Telugu	<i>dhanyavādamulu</i>	Sanskrit — same word
Hindi	<i>dhanyavād</i>	Sanskrit — same word
Tamil	<i>nanri</i>	native (“goodness”)
Malayalam	<i>nandi</i>	native — Tamil’s cousin

A stark split: Kannada, Telugu, Hindi take the Sanskrit word; Tamil and Malayalam keep native *nanri* / *nandi*.

1.3 ಹೌದು (*haudu*) — “yes”

The letters in this word

ಹೌ is *hau* (ಹ *ha* with the “au” vowel sign hugging it); ದು is *du* (ದ *da* with the “u” sign beneath). Read ಹೌ·ದು → *haudu*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೌದು (*haudu*) is the everyday “yes / that’s so” — a genuinely **native** Kannada word, after two Sanskrit loans.

Grammar Lens

Like its sister Tamil, Kannada often says “yes” by **echoing the verb**: asked *bandiddīyā?* (“have you come?”), a natural yes is *bandiddēne* (“I have come”). Bank *haudu* as the simple word, but expect a “yes” to come back as a whole verb — a habit shared across the Dravidian family.

1.4 ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*) — “no,” a word Tamil shares almost exactly

The letters in this word

ಇ is the **independent vowel** “i” (word-initial, so a full letter). ಲ್ಲ is “lla” — ಲ *la* vowel-stripped and stacked under another *la*, a held “ll.” Read ಇಲ್ಲ → *illa*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*) is built on the old Dravidian root *il*, “not-being” — so, like Tamil *illai*, it really means “[it] is not, [there] is not,” serving as the everyday “no.” Its positive twin is ಇದೆ (*ide*), “there is.”

Grammar Lens

Dravidian negates by *being*. Where English inserts *not*, Kannada — exactly like Tamil — swaps in the negative verb of existence: *pustaka ide* (“there *is* a book”) → *pustaka illa* (“there *is not* a book”). A shared inheritance: Tamil *illai*, Kannada *illa*, Malayalam *illa* — one family, one way to say a thing is not.

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“No / isn’t”	Note
Kannada	ಇಲ್ಲ <i>illa</i>	native (root <i>il</i>)
Tamil	<i>illai</i>	the <i>same</i> root
Malayalam	<i>illa</i>	the <i>same</i> root
Telugu	<i>lēdu</i>	native, a different root
Hindi	<i>nahīnī</i>	Indo-European (unrelated)

1.5 ಸರಿ (*sari*) — “okay,” shared whole with Tamil**The letters in this word**

ಸ is *sa*; ರಿ is *ri* (ರ *ra* with the “i” sign). No conjunct here — two clean, round syllables. Read ಸ·ರಿ → *sari*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಸರಿ (*sari*) is native Dravidian for “correct, even, right,” and so “okay, agreed” — the verbal nod of Kannada. It is the *same word* as Tamil *sari* — identical in sound and meaning, only the script differs; doubled, *sari sari* means “alright, alright.”

Grammar Lens

One shared word, two scripts. *sari* is identical in Kannada and Tamil in sound and meaning — only the letters differ (Kannada writes it ಸರಿ, Tamil in its own script). Watching a shared word change its clothes but not its sound is the fastest way to feel how close these languages are — the pattern-matching that carries you across Kannada, Telugu, and Malayalam.

1.6 Recap, and how Kannada says goodbye

Read		Meaning	Origin
ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ	<i>namaskāra</i>	hello	Sanskrit
ಧನ್ಯವಾದ	<i>dhanyavāda</i>	thank you	Sanskrit
ಹೌದು	<i>haudu</i>	yes	native
ಇಲ್ಲ	<i>illa</i>	no / isn’t	native (= Tamil <i>illai</i>)
ಸರಿ	<i>sari</i>	okay	native (= Tamil <i>sari</i>)

The pattern is already visible: the two greeting/politeness words are Sanskrit loans; the three everyday grammar words are native Dravidian, two of them shared almost unchanged with Tamil.

Why it's said this way

The same “go and come back” as Tamil. Kannada, too, avoids a bare “I’m leaving.” The everyday goodbye is ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (*hōgi baruttēne*), “having gone, I [will] come [back],” and the reply is ಹೋಗಿ ಬನ್ನಿ (*hōgi banni*), “go, and come back.” The very worldview you met in Tamil’s *pōy varugirēn*: never simply depart — promise a return.

Next chapter: introducing yourself — *nanna hesaru...* (“my name...”) — and Kannada’s *nīnu* / *nīvu* (familiar / respectful “you”).

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Now a first real exchange — giving your name, asking for someone else’s, and saying you’re glad to meet them:

ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ಅರುಣ್. (nanna hesaru Arun — “My name is Arun.”)
ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು? (nimma hesaru ēnu — “What is your name?”)

Built the same way as the greetings — each piece taken apart, its letters and its root, then assembled. *Practice lessons: lessons/KA-C02-*.md.*

2.1 ಹೆಸರು (*hesaru*) — “name,” and the *p*-to-*h* shift

The letters in this word

ಹ (*ha*) + ೀ (the *e*-sign) → ಹೆ (*he*); ಸ (*sa*); ರು (*ru*). Read ಹೆ·ಸ·ರು → *hesaru*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೆಸರು (*hesaru*, “name”) is **native Dravidian**, from Proto-Dravidian *pesar — and it hides a famous Kannada sound-law: an old initial *p* became *h*. So *pesar → *hesar → *hesaru*. That makes it a *cousin* of Tamil *peyar* (same root; Tamil kept the *p*, Kannada softened it to *h*) — and, like *peyar*, *not* related to the Sanskrit *nāma* (Hindi *nām*, English *name*). The Dravidian south kept its own word for “name.”

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“Name”	Source
Kannada	ಹೆಸರು <i>hesaru</i>	Dravidian *pesar (p→h)
Tamil	<i>peyar</i>	the <i>same</i> Dravidian root (kept <i>p</i>)
Telugu	<i>pēru</i>	the <i>same</i> Dravidian root
Malayalam	<i>pēr</i>	the <i>same</i> Dravidian root
Hindi	<i>nām</i>	Sanskrit (Indo-European)
English	<i>name</i>	Indo-European

The $p \rightarrow h$ shift is why *hesaru* looks unlike its sisters — but it is the same word.

2.2 ನನ್ನ (*nanna*) — “my”

The letters in this word

ನ (*na*) + the conjunct ನ್ನ (*nn*) → *nanna* — a doubled, held *nn*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನನ್ನ (*nanna*, “my”) is the possessive of ನಾನು (*nānu*, “I”) — native Dravidian, on the pronoun stem *nān, the same one behind Tamil *nān* / *en*. It has no Indo-European cousin: the Dravidian “I/my” is a different word from the European *I/my*.

2.3 ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ... (*nanna hesaru ...*) — “my name is...”

ನನ್ನ (my) + ಹೆಸರು (name) + name = **nanna hesaru ...** *Nanna hesaru Arun.*
= “My name is Arun.”

Grammar Lens

No word for “is.” As in Tamil, notice there is *no* verb: Kannada sets “my name” beside “Arun” and lets the “is” be understood — the **zero copula** of the Dravidian family. *Nanna hesaru Arun* = literally “my name Arun.”

2.4 ನೀನು / ನೀವು (*nīnu* / *nīvu*) — “you,” familiar and respectful

The letters in this word

ನೀ (*nī*) + ನು (*nu*) → *nīnu*; ನೀ + ವು (*vu*) → *nīvu*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನೀನು (*nīnu*, familiar “you”) ← Proto-Dravidian **nīn* — the same native root as Tamil *nī*. ನೀವು (*nīvu*) is the respectful/plural “you.”

Grammar Lens

Respect by the plural, once more. *nīnu* (familiar) vs. *nīvu* (respectful, and literally plural) — the same politeness-by-plural as Tamil *nīṇṇaḷ* and French *vous*. For a first meeting, *nīvu*.

2.5 ಏನು (*ēnu*) — “what”

The letters in this word

ಏ (independent long *ē*, word-initial) + ನು (*nu*) → *ēnu*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಏನು (*ēnu*, “what”) is native Dravidian, on the interrogative stem **yā-* / **e-* — the same Dravidian question-root as Tamil *eṇṇa*, heading Kannada’s question family: *ēnu* (what), *yāru* (who), *elli* (where), *yāke* (why).

2.6 ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು? — “what’s your name?”

ನಿಮ್ಮ (*nimma*, “your”) is the possessive of *nīvu* (“you,” respectful). So ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು? is literally “**your name what?**” — and again *no “is.”* Three words, no verb.

Grammar Lens

Answer with the sentence you built: *Nanna hesaru Arun*. The familiar “your” is *ninna* (from *nīnu*): *ninna hesaru ēnu?*

2.7 ಸಂತೋಷ (santōṣa) — “joy,” and “pleased to meet you”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The warm close is ನಿಮ್ಮನ್ನು ಭೇಟಿಯಾಗಿ ಸಂತೋಷ (nimmannu bhēṭiyāgi santōṣa) — “**having met you, joy.**” But note the key word: ಸಂತೋಷ (santōṣa, “joy, contentment”) is **Sanskrit** (*sam-* “fully” + *toṣa* “satisfaction”), not native. Where Tamil reaches for its home-grown *magilcci*, Kannada — true to form — uses a Sanskrit word even for “pleased.” The same split you saw over “hello” and “thanks” runs right through the introductions.

2.8 The whole exchange

Kannada		English
ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ಮೀರಾ.	<i>nanna hesaru Mira</i>	My name is Mira.
ನಿಮ್ಮ ಹೆಸರು ಏನು?	<i>nimma hesaru ēnu</i>	What’s your name?
ನನ್ನ ಹೆಸರು ಅರುಣ್.	<i>nanna hesaru Arun</i>	My name is Arun.
ಸಂತೋಷ.	<i>santōṣa</i>	Pleased to meet you.

Every atom traced: *hesaru* (Dravidian *pesar, p→h; *not name*), *nanna* (from *nānu*, “I”), *ēnu* (Dravidian question-stem) — and *santōṣa*, a Sanskrit loan for “pleased,” the family thread again. The Kannada habit to keep: the **zero copula** (no “is”). Next chapter: *hēgiddīra?* (“how are you?”) and answering with *chennāgiddēne* — the responding cycle.

Chapter 3

How Are You?

After the name comes the exchange everyone actually has — carried by the Dravidian verb “to be”:

ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? (nīvu hēgiddīrā — “How are you?”)
ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ, ಧನ್ಯವಾದ. (nānu cennāgiddēne, dhanyavāda — “I’m well, thank you.”)

Practice lessons: *lessons/KA-C03-*.md*.

3.1 ಹೇಗೆ (hēge) — “how,” another of the ē- questions

The letters in this word

ಹೇ (hē) + ಗೆ (ge) → ಹೇಗೆ (hēge).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೇಗೆ (hēge, “how”) is native Dravidian, on the interrogative base ē-/yā- from ēnu. Kannada gathers its questions here: ēnu (what), hēge (how), yāru (who), elli (where), yāvāga (when). It is the same Dravidian question-root heading Tamil’s *eppaṭi* and Telugu’s *elā* — a family older than the Sanskrit words Kannada otherwise borrows so readily.

3.2 ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ? — “how are you?”

The new word is ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ (hēgiddīrā): hēge (“how”) fused with the verb ಇರು (iru, “to be, exist, stay”) + the respectful-you ending. So ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ?

is “you how are?”, the verb last, as in every Kannada sentence. The verb *iru* is the very same native Dravidian “to be” that Tamil uses — and (Chapter 5) the verb for “I live.”

Grammar Lens

The verb carries “you.” The ending already means “you (respectful),” so *nīvu* can be dropped. To a friend: ನೀನು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀಯಾ? (*nīnu hēgiddīyā?*). Match the “you” to the verb-ending.

3.3 ನಾನು (*nānu*) — “I,” the Dravidian first person

The letters in this word

ನಾ (*nā*) + ನು (*nu*) → ನಾನು (*nānu*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನಾನು (*nānu*, “I”) ← Proto-Dravidian **yān* / **nān* — native, and (unlike Hindi’s *maiṃ*, cousin of English *me*) **not** related to the European “I/me” family. Its possessive is the ನನ್ನ (*nanna*, “my”) you met in Chapter 2. Kannada borrows Sanskrit freely for higher vocabulary, but its bedrock pronouns stayed Dravidian.

3.4 ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ (*cennāgi*) — “well,” and how to answer

The letters in this word

ಚೆ (*ce* — the letter ಚ is “ch as in *cheese*”) + ನ್ನಾ (*nnā*) + ಗಿ (*gi*) → ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿ (*cennāgi*, “well, nicely”) is native Dravidian, from ಚೆನ್ನು (*cennu*, “good, beautiful”) + the adverb-maker *-āgi* (“in a ... way”) — so it means, at heart, “in a beautiful way.” The root *cennu* is pure Kannada, no Sanskrit or European cousin.

Fuse it with *iru*: ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ (*nānu cennāgiddēne*) — “I am well.”

3.5 ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ (*paravāgilla*) — “no problem”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ means “it does not matter / there is no harm” — *paravā* (“harm”) + ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*, “is-not”), the Chapter-1 negative. It serves as “it’s okay / no worries / you’re welcome.” The atom ಇಲ್ಲ (*illa*) is Kannada’s “is-not,” the mirror of *iru* (“is”). It is shared, almost unchanged, across **Kannada, Tamil, and Malayalam** — a deep Dravidian bond; only Telugu breaks away to *lēdu* (so Telugu’s “no problem” is *paravāledu*, Kannada’s *paravāgilla*).

Grammar Lens

Illa negates existence and stands alone as “no”: *duḍḍu illa* (“there’s no money”). Hold *iru* / *illa* together — “is” and “is-not.”

3.6 The whole exchange

Kannada	English
ನೀವು ಹೇಗಿದ್ದೀರಾ?	How are you?
ನಾನು ಚೆನ್ನಾಗಿದ್ದೇನೆ, ಧನ್ಯವಾದ.	I'm well, thank you.
ಪರವಾಗಿಲ್ಲ.	No problem / you're welcome.

Every atom is traced. *Hēge* belongs to the native *ē*- question family; *nānu* is Proto-Dravidian, unrelated to *me*; and *cennāgi* means “beautifully.” The *iru* / *illa* pair supplies “is” and “is-not,” with *illa* shared by Tamil and Malayalam. Next chapter: the farewells — and Kannada, like all its family, never says a plain “goodbye.”

Chapter 4

Farewells

Kannada, like every Dravidian language, does not say a plain “goodbye.” It promises to return:

ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ. (*hōgi baruttēne* — “I’ll go and come back.”)

Practice lessons: lessons/KA-CO4-.md.*

4.1 ಹೋಗು (*hōgu*) — “go,” and ಬಾ (come)

The letters in this word

ಹೋ (*hō*) + ಗು (*gu*) → ಹೋಗು. Its partner ಬಾ (*bā*, “come”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹೋಗು (*hōgu*, “to go”) and ಬಾ (*bā*, “come”) are native Dravidian verbs. As commands they are whole words: *hōgu!* (“go!”), *bā!* (“come!”). You need both, because Kannada’s goodbye is “I go, and I *come back*.”

4.2 ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (*hōgi baruttēne*) — “I’ll go and come back”

ಹೋಗಿ (*hōgi*, “having gone”) + ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ (*baruttēne*, “I come”) — literally “**having gone, I come [back]**,” i.e. “I’ll go and come back.” A Kannada speaker never signs off with a bare “I’m leaving.” The warm reply is ಹೋಗಿ ಬನ್ನಿ (*hōgi banni*, “go and come [back]”).

Across the family — the same idea, five ways

Language	“go and come back” (goodbye)
Kannada	<i>hōgi baruttēne</i>
Tamil	<i>pōy varugirēṇ</i>
Telugu	<i>velli vastānu</i>
Malayalam	<i>pōyi varām</i>
Bengali (Indo-Aryan)	<i>āshi</i> (“I come”)

The whole south, and beyond, prefers a promise of return to a blunt farewell.

4.3 ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ (*nāḷe sigōṇa*) — “see you tomorrow”

The letters in this word

ನಾಳೆ (*nāḷe*): ನಾ (*nā*) + ಳೆ (*ḷe*, retroflex ಳ *ḷ*). ಸಿಗೋಣ (*sigōṇa*) = *sigu* (“meet”) + *-ōṇa* (“let’s”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನಾಳೆ (*nāḷe*, “tomorrow”) is native, from *nāl* (“day”) — the same root as Tamil’s *nālai*. ಸಿಗು (*sigu*, “to meet, be found”) gives *sigōṇa* (“let’s meet”) — “tomorrow, let’s meet.” The *-ōṇa* ending is Kannada’s warm “let’s ...”: *hōgōṇa* (“let’s go”).

4.4 ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ — “we’ll meet again”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ = ಮತ್ತೆ (*matte*, “again”) + *sigōṇa* (“let’s meet”). Both are native Dravidian: *matte* (“again”) and *sigu* (“to meet”). Where Tamil’s “we’ll meet again” reaches for the Sanskrit loan *sandi*, Kannada keeps the native *sigu* — the same phrase, from home-grown stock.

4.5 The farewells

Kannada	English
ಹೋಗಿ ಬರುತ್ತೇನೆ.	I'll go and come back. (goodbye)
ಹೋಗಿ ಬನ್ನಿ.	Go and come back. (the reply)
ನಾಳೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ.	See you tomorrow.
ಮತ್ತೆ ಸಿಗೋಣ.	We'll meet again.

Roots banked: *hōgu/bā* (go/come), *nāle* (“tomorrow” ← *nāl* “day,” shared with Tamil), and *sigu* (“meet,” native — where Tamil borrowed *sandi*). Next chapter: the first real verbs — *nānu kannada mātanāḍuttēne* — and Kannada’s sentences begin to move.

Chapter 5

The First Verbs

Until now, “to be” and “to be-not.” Now verbs that *act* — and Kannada’s sentences begin to move:

ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ. (*nānu kannaḍa mātanāḍuttēne* — “I speak Kannada.”)

Practice lessons: lessons/KA-C05-.md.*

5.1 ಮಾತನಾಡು (*mātanāḍu*) — “to speak,” your first full verb

The letters in this word

ಮಾ (*mā*) + ತೆ (*ta*) + ನಾ (*nā*) + ಡು (*ḍu*) → ಮಾತನಾಡು.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಾತನಾಡು (*mātanāḍu*, “to speak”) is native Dravidian, built on ಮಾತು (*mātu*, “word, speech”). To say “I speak,” Kannada stacks two endings on the stem — tense then person:

$mātanāḍ- + -utt-$ (present) + $-ēne$ (“I”) → ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ
(*mātanāḍuttēne*), “I speak.”

The $-ēne$ ending is “I,” so *nānu* is rarely needed: *mātanāḍuttāne* (he), *mātanāḍuttāṇe* (she), *mātanāḍuttāre* (they / you-respectful).

Grammar Lens

Stem + tense + person. Every Kannada verb is built this way. And, like Tamil and Telugu, Kannada marks **no gender in the first person**: *mātanāḍuttēne* is the same for a man or a woman.

5.2 ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ — “I speak Kannada”

ನಾನು (I) + ಕನ್ನಡ (*kannāḍa*, the object) + ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ (speak) — “I Kannada speak,” verb last. The name ಕನ್ನಡ (*kannāḍa*) is native, often linked to *kar-nāḍu* (“the high/black land,” whence *Karnataka*). Kannada has a literature over a thousand years old and a store of classical honours — a classical tongue of some fifty million speakers.

Grammar Lens

No gender on “I speak.” *Mātanāḍuttēne* is the same whether a man or a woman says it — Kannada, like Tamil and Telugu, marks no gender in the first or second person (only the third: *-āne* he, *-āle* she).

5.3 ಇರು (*iru*) — “to be, to stay, to live”**The word, taken apart — its roots and family**

ಇರು (*iru*, “to be, exist, stay, live”) is native Dravidian — the very same *iru* Tamil uses, and the verb behind Chapter 3’s *hēgiddirā* (“how are you”) and *cennāgiddēne* (“I’m well”). It also means “to reside”: ನಾನು ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಇದ್ದೇನೆ (*nānu Beṅgalūrinalli iddēne*, “I live in Bangalore”). One verb covers “be,” “stay,” and “live.”

Grammar Lens

“In” comes after the noun. ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನಲ್ಲಿ (*Beṅgalūrinalli*) = *Beṅgalūru* + *-alli* (“in”), glued to the *end* of the noun. Kannada uses **postpositions** (case-suffixes): “Bangalore-in I am,” the verb last.

5.4 ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು (*kelasa māḍu*) — “to work”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಾಡು (*māḍu*, “to do, make”) is a core native verb, and Kannada — like Hindi with *karnā*, Tamil with *sey*, and Telugu with *cēyu* — builds compounds by putting a noun in front of it: ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡು (*kelasa māḍu*, “work-do” = “to work”), *aḍuge māḍu* (“to cook”), *sahāya māḍu* (“to help,” with a **Sanskrit** noun on the **native** *māḍu*). So “I work” is ನಾನು ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ (*nānu kelasa māḍuttēne*).

Grammar Lens

Noun + ಮಾಡು = a new verb — the exact twin of Hindi’s “noun + *karnā*,” Tamil’s “noun + *sey*,” and Telugu’s “noun + *cēyu*.” Four languages, two from an unrelated family, all landed on the same trick.

5.5 Sentences about yourself

Kannada	English
ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ.	I speak Kannada.
ನಾನು ಬೆಂಗಳೂರಿನಲ್ಲಿ ಇದ್ದೇನೆ.	I live in Bangalore.
ನಾನು ಕೆಲಸ ಮಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ.	I work.

Three verbs, one engine: a stem, a tense-marker, a person-ending, the verb always last — and no gender in the first person. Roots banked: *mā-tanāḍu* (speak ← *mātu* “word”), *iru* (be/stay/live, with *-alli* “in” on the noun’s end), and *māḍu* (do → *kelasa māḍu* “to work,” the twin of Hindi’s *karnā*). From here, Kannada’s sentences only grow.

Chapter 6

Case Endings and Dative Subjects

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

6.1 -ಗೆ (-ge) — “to, for”

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Your first **case ending**. English puts “to” in **front**, as a separate word. Kannada sticks it on the **back** — the biggest structural fact about the language, in one suffix.

You’ll want to know: Adding it on

word	+ -ge	meaning
ಹೆಸರು <i>hesaru</i> — name	ಹೆಸರಿಗೆ <i>hesarige</i>	to/for the name
ಕೆಲಸ <i>kelasa</i> — work	ಕೆಲಸಕ್ಕೆ <i>kelasakke</i>	for work

Two shapes, one suffix: **-ige** after some stems, **-kke** after others. Kannada adjusts it to fit the word in front — but you can still see exactly where the noun stops and the ending starts.

And with “I”, which reshapes first:

ನಾನು *nānu* (“I”) → ನನಗೆ *nanage* (“to me”)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

All four descend from one Proto-Dravidian dative, **-k(k)u**. Look at what became of its *k*:

language	dative
Tamil	-ukku
Telugu	-ku / -ki
Malayalam	-ikku / -inu
Kannada	-ge / -ige

Kannada is the one that **voiced** it — $k \rightarrow g$ between vowels — and carried that change into the dative, where its sisters kept the hard consonant. Note the other Kannada form, **-kke**: a **doubled** consonant resists voicing, so the geminate preserved the original k . The two Kannada shapes are the same suffix caught on either side of a sound change.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “hesaru ... hesarige”]
- [YOU SAY: “nānu ... nanage” — “I” ... “to me”]
- [YOU SAY: “kelasakke” — “for work,” from Ch. 5’s ಕೆಲಸ]
- [YOU SAY: the family — “-ukku · -ku · -ge · -ikku”]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What does **-ಗೆ** mean? (“**To**” or “**for**.”) Where does it go? (**On the end** of the noun.) What is “to me”? (ನನಗೆ *nanage*.) Why does Kannada have g where its sisters have k ? (Kannada **voiced** the k between vowels; doubled **-kke** resisted and kept the old hard form.)

6.2 -ಗೆ — one suffix, one job

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You can now attach **-ಗೆ** and make ನನಗೆ “to me.” Look at what that visible seam tells you about how Kannada builds longer words.

Grammar Lens: Stacking versus fusion

	Kannada -ge	a Latin ending like -īs
pins down the case?	yes — dative, always	no — dative or ablative
carries number?	no — a separate suffix does	yes — plural, baked in
carries declension class?	no	yes — first or second
can you see the seam?	yes: <i>hesar + ige</i>	no — one fused lump

Kannada **stacks** suffixes. Each suffix carries one meaning and sits in a fixed order, so the learner can see where the noun ends and the case marker begins. That is what **agglutinative** means here: longer words are assembled from pieces whose jobs remain visible.

Latin **fuses** several jobs into one ending. *-īs* carries case, plural number, and declension class at once—and it does not even settle whether the case is dative or ablative. Kannada **-ಗಿ** carries one unambiguous job: “to/for.”

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: *hesar + ige* — a visible noun-plus-case seam]
- [YOU SAY: Kannada *-ge* — one job, dative]
- [YOU SAY: Latin *-īs* — case, plural, and declension fused]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Why is Kannada called agglutinative? (**It stacks visible pieces, each with one job.**) How many jobs can Latin *-īs* fuse? (**Case, number, and declension class—and its case can still be dative or ablative.**)

6.3 ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು — “I know Kannada”

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Chapter 5 gave you ನಾನು ಕನ್ನಡ — “I speak Kannada” — with the verb ಮಾತನಾಡುತ್ತೇನೆ. Now say “I know Kannada.” Kannada will not let you use *nānu*.

You’ll want to know: The sentence

ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು. *nanage kannada gottu*. literally: “to-me Kannada [is] known.”

piece

ನನಗೆ <i>nanage</i>	“to me” — the dative from the last lesson
ಕನ್ನಡ <i>kannada</i>	Kannada (Ch. 5)
ಗೊತ್ತು <i>gottu</i>	“known”

Two things to notice. **You are not the subject** — *nānu* is gone, moved into the dative, leaving *kannada* as the unmarked word the sentence is about. And *gottu* isn’t really a verb doing an action; it’s closer to “[is] known.” So nothing in this sentence is *doing* anything at all.

Grammar Lens: Why: things that happen *to* you

Kannada separates what you **do** from what **happens to** you. Speaking is an action, so Ch. 5 used *nānu*. But knowing, liking, wanting, being hungry — these **arrive**. Kannada marks that by putting the person in the **dative**.

English frames it as	Kannada frames it as
I know Kannada	Kannada is known to me
I like it	it is pleasing to me
I am cold	cold is to me

English keeps one fossil of the same idea: “**methinks**” — where *me* is a dative, “it seems **to me**.” Kannada made it a rule.

Grammar Lens: All four sisters do it

language	“I know [the language]”	the dative
Kannada	<i>nanage kannada gottu</i>	-ge
Tamil	<i>enakku tamil teriyum</i>	-ukku
Telugu	<i>nāku telugu vaccu</i>	-ku
Malayalam	<i>enikku malayālam ariyām</i>	-ikku

One construction, four languages, four suffixes that are visibly the **same suffix** — Kannada’s *g* being the softened *k* of the others. The Dravidian family showing its bones, exactly as *blanc/bianco/branco* did for Romance.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “*nanage kannada gottu*”]
- [YOU SAY: the contrast — “*nānu kannada mātanāḍuttēne*” (I speak) ... “*nanage kannada gottu*” (known to me)]
- [YOU SAY: the literal — “to-me Kannada known”]
- [YOU SAY: the four cousins — “*-ge · -ukku · -ku · -ikku*”]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What does ನನಗೆ ಕನ್ನಡ ಗೊತ್ತು literally say? (“**To-me** Kannada **known**.”) What has English got that Kannada hasn’t? (A nominative “**I**” — *nānu* is replaced by the dative *nanage*.) Is *gottu* an action verb? (**No** — it’s “[is] known”; nothing is doing anything.) Why the dative? (Knowing **happens to** you.) Which English word keeps the same idea? (**Methinks**.)

Chapter 7

Numbers One to Ten

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

7.1 ಒಂದು, ಎರಡು, ಮೂರು, ನಾಲ್ಕು, ಐದು — one to five

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] If you walked here through Tamil, you already know these numbers — Kannada just says them with its own accent.

You'll want to know: The five

	numeral	word	said
1	೧	ಒಂದು	<i>ondu</i>
2	೨	ಎರಡು	<i>eraḍu</i>
3	೩	ಮೂರು	<i>mūru</i>
4	೪	ನಾಲ್ಕು	<i>nālku</i>
5	೫	ಐದು	<i>aidu</i>

The single symbols ೧ ೨ ೩ ೪ ೫ are Kannada's own digits — you'll meet them on bus numbers and prices, distinct from the words above.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

These are **native Dravidian** numbers, not Sanskrit borrowings — the same word-stock Tamil kept. Line them up against Tamil and they are plainly the same word wearing a Kannada coat:

	Tamil	Kannada
2	<i>iraṇṭu</i>	eraḍu
3	<i>mūṇru</i>	mūru
4	<i>nāṅku</i>	nāḷku
5	<i>aintu</i>	aidu
One is the family’s odd number: Tamil <i>onru</i> and Kannada <i>ondu</i> are cousins (from an old <i>on-</i>), but Telugu will break rank with <i>okaṭi</i> when you get there. So learn <i>ondu</i> now, but expect Telugu’s “one” to surprise you.		

Grammar Lens: A Kannada habit to notice

The **anusvara** — the small circle ◌◌ in ಒಂದು (*on-du*) — is a nasal that takes its colour from the letter after it: an *n* before *d* in *ondu*, an *m* before *b* later in *ombattu* (nine). One mark, whatever nasal the next consonant needs. You’ll see it constantly.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “ondu, eraḍu, mūru, nāḷku, aidu”]
- [YOU SAY: the Tamil→Kannada shift — “iraṇṭu → eraḍu”, same number, new coat]
- [YOU SAY: read the digits — ೧ ೨ ೩ ೪ ೫]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Count to five in Kannada. (*Ondu, eraḍu, mūru, nāḷku, aidu.*) Are these borrowed from Sanskrit? (**No** — native Dravidian, shared with Tamil.) Which number will Telugu form differently? (**One** — *okaṭi*, vs Kannada *ondu*.) What does the ◌◌ anusvara do in *ondu*? (Stands for the nasal the next consonant needs — here *n* before *d*.) Next: six to ten.

7.2 ಆರು, ಏಳು, ಎಂಟು, ಒಂಬತ್ತು, ಹತ್ತು — six to ten

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Five more — and the last one shows the single sound-change that most makes Kannada *sound* like Kannada.

You'll want to know: The five

	numeral	word	said
6	ಓ	ಆರು	<i>āru</i>
7	ಒ	ಏಳು	<i>ēlu</i>
8	ಊ	ಎಂಟು	<i>eṇṭu</i>
9	ಋ	ಒಂಬತ್ತು	<i>ombattu</i>
10	ೠೡ	ಹತ್ತು	<i>hattu</i>

(Ten needs two digits — ೠೡ, a one and a zero — just like 10.)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Put ten beside Tamil:

Tamil **pattu** → Kannada **hattu**.

Kannada systematically softened an old word-initial **p-** into **h-**. It isn't a one-off: it runs right through the language —

	Tamil	Kannada
ten	<i>pattu</i>	hattu
milk	<i>pāl</i>	hālu
tooth	<i>pal</i>	hallu

Once you know the rule, a Kannada *h-* word often hands you its Tamil cousin for free: hide the *h-*, restore a *p-*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Six and seven stay close cousins (Tamil *āru* / Kannada *āru*; Tamil *ēlu* / Kannada *ēlu* — note Kannada hardened Tamil's rare **ḷ** into an ordinary retroflex **ḷ**). **Eight and nine** wander more: Kannada *eṇṭu* and *ombattu* are still relatives of Tamil *eṇṭu* and *onpatu*, but **Telugu** leaves the family entirely there (*enimidi*, *tommidi*) — so treat 8–9 as the loose cells.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “āru, ēḷu, eṇṭu, ombattu, hattu”]
- [YOU SAY: the shift — “pattu → hattu”, “pāl → hālu”: hide the h, find the p]
- [YOU SAY: read the digits — ಒ ೨ ೩ ೪ ೫ ೧೦]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Count six to ten in Kannada. (*Āru, ēḷu, eṇṭu, ombattu, hattu.*) What regular shift turns Tamil *pattu* into Kannada *hattu*? (Word-initial **p-** → **h-** — also *pāl* → *hālu*.) What happened to Tamil’s rare **ḷ** in Kannada *ēḷu*? (It hardened into an ordinary retroflex **ḷ**.) Which numbers should you trust least as family cousins? (**Eight and nine** — Telugu especially wanders.)

Chapter 8

Please

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

8.1 ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು (dayaviṭṭu) — please (having placed compassion)

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Kannada’s everyday “please” is, once you open it up, a small act of generosity: “having **placed** compassion” between us.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು = please, literally “**having placed compassion / kindness.**” Two pieces:

- ದಯ (daya) = **compassion, kindness, grace** — from Sanskrit **daya**.
- ಇಟ್ಟು (iṭṭu) = “**having placed / set down,**” from the verb ಇಡು (idu) “to place, to put.”

So *dayaviṭṭu* means, at heart, *setting kindness down (before you)* — asking the listener to act from compassion.

That is exactly how **Tamil** builds it (*tayavu seytu*, “**do** the kindness”), and the same instinct as **Arabic** *min faḍlik* (“from your **grace**”) and **Hindi** *kṛpayā* (from *kṛpā*, “**compassion**”). A wide arc of Asia says *please* by naming the kindness it hopes for.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

daya + a light verb, four times over:

- Kannada ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು *dayaviṭṭu* — compassion + **having placed**
- Tamil தயவுசெய்து *tayavu seytu* — kindness + **do**
- Telugu దయచేసి *dayacēsi* — compassion + **having done**
- Malayalam ദയവായി *dayavāyi* — compassion + **as / having become**

Why it's said this way

The honest note: a standalone please-word is a little **formal / emphatic**. Everyday Kannada politeness leans on the **respectful command** — the verb ending *-i* (ಕುಳಿತುಕೊಳ್ಳಿ *kulitukolli* “please sit,” ಹೇಳಿ *hēli* “please tell me.” That ending already means “please” do this. Add ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು in front when you want to underline the courtesy.

The letters in this word

Look at ಟ್ಟು — a **doubled** *t*. The first ಟ್ is *ta* silenced by the **virama** (its vowel cut), and it tucks **under** the next letter as an *ottu* (a subscript form) before ಟು *tu*. Kannada writes a double consonant by stacking, not repeating side by side — a neat contrast with how the Roman alphabet just writes “tt.”

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “daya” — compassion — then “iṭṭu,” having placed]
- [YOU SAY: the whole word — “dayaviṭṭu” = please]
- [YOU SAY: the everyday way — the verb ending: “kulitukolli” = please sit]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What is the Kannada word for please? (ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು *dayavittu*.) What do its pieces mean? (“**Compassion**” *daya* + “**having placed**” *ittu*.) Which cousins ask the same way? (**Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam** with *daya* — plus **Arabic** *fādl*, **Hindi** *kṛpā*.) What carries “please” in ordinary speech? (**The respectful verb ending** -ಇ -*i*.)

Chapter 9

Sorry

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

9.1 ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ (kṣamisi) — forgive me / sorry

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You already know ದಯವಿಟ್ಟು, “please.” Kannada’s “sorry” reuses a trick you’ll see everywhere in this language: taking a Sanskrit noun and turning it into a working Kannada verb.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- ಕ್ಷಮಾ (*kṣamā*) = “**patience, forbearance, forgiveness**” — a Sanskrit noun, unchanged.
- -ಇಸು (*-isu*) = a **verb-making suffix**: bolt it onto a Sanskrit noun and you get a brand-new Kannada verb. *kṣamā* + *-isu* → ಕ್ಷಮಿಸು (*kṣamisu*), “**to forgive**.” (The same move builds ಪ್ರಾರಂಭಿಸು *prārambhisu*, “to begin,” from Sanskrit *prārambha*.)
- -ಃ (*-i*) = the plain **imperative** ending — the very one you met on ಕುಲಿತುಕೊಲ್ಲಿ (*kulitukolli*) (“please sit”) in the please lesson.

So ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ is simply “**forgive!**” — *kṣamisu* wearing its imperative ending.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Three of the four Dravidian cousins build “sorry” from the very same Sanskrit noun, each with its own verb-making suffix and its own imperative shape:

- Kannada ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ *kṣamisi* — Sanskrit *kṣamā* + **-isu** (verb) + **-i** (imperative)
- Telugu క్షమించండి *kṣamiṇcaṇḍi* — Sanskrit *kṣamā* + **-iñcu** (verb) + **-aṇḍi** (imperative)
- Malayalam ക്ഷമിക്കണം *kṣamikkanaṁ* — Sanskrit *kṣama* + **-ikkuka** (verb) + **-aṇaṁ** (necessitative)
- Tamil மன்னிக்கவும் *maṇṇikkavum* — its **own** native root *maṇṇi*, not Sanskrit at all

Why it’s said this way

ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ is a genuine, everyday way to say “sorry” — not overly formal — but in casual conversation you’ll also hear the softer ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ ಬಿಡಿ (*kṣamisi biḍi*, roughly “just forgive [it]”) or simply the borrowed English “**sorry**,” which is extremely common in spoken Kannada.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “kṣamā” — the Sanskrit noun, patience/forgiveness]
- [YOU SAY: the verb — “kṣamisu,” to forgive — then “kṣamisi,” forgive!]
- [YOU SAY: contrast — Tamil’s *maṇṇikkavum* uses its own root instead]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What is ಕ್ಷಮಿಸಿ built from? (Sanskrit *kṣamā* “forgiveness” + the verb-making suffix **-isu** + the imperative **-i**.) Which cousin languages do the same trick, and which one doesn’t? (Telugu and Malayalam also verb-ify *kṣamā*; Tamil uses its own native

root *manni* instead.) What do people often say casually instead?
(**Kṣamisi biḍi**, or simply borrowed English “**sorry**.”)

Chapter 10

Days of the Week

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

10.1 ಸೋಮವಾರ to ಭಾನುವಾರ — the Sanskrit week

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Unlike Tamil and Malayalam, Kannada’s week is built entirely from Sanskrit — the same recipe as Hindi’s. But even here, one day picks a **different** Sanskrit word than Hindi does.

You’ll want to know: The pattern: [deity] + ವಾರ, “day”

Kannada	deity/planet	day
ಸೋಮವಾರ (<i>Somavāra</i>)	Moon (Soma)	Monday
ಮಂಗಳವಾರ (<i>Maṅgalavāra</i>)	Mars (Maṅgala)	Tuesday
ಬುಧವಾರ (<i>Budhavāra</i>)	Mercury (Budha)	Wednesday
ಗುರುವಾರ (<i>Guruvāra</i>)	Jupiter (Guru/Bṛhaspati)	Thursday
ಶುಕ್ರವಾರ (<i>Śukravāra</i>)	Venus (Śukra)	Friday
ಶನಿವಾರ (<i>Śanivāra</i>)	Saturn (Śani)	Saturday
ಭಾನುವಾರ (<i>Bhānuvāra</i>)	the Sun (Bhānu, “light, splendor”)	Sunday

Five of these are identical in shape to Hindi’s — same deity, same **-vāra/-vār** ending. **Sunday** is the interesting exception: where Hindi says रविवार

(*Ravivār*, from *Ravi*, “sun”), Kannada says ಭಾನುವಾರ (*Bhānuvāra*), built on a **different** Sanskrit word for the sun — **Bhānu**, “light, splendor,” rather than *Ravi*. Sanskrit has **many** names for the sun, and different languages downstream picked different ones for their week.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “Somavāra, Maṅgalavāra, Budhavāra, Guruvāra, Śukravāra, Śanivāra” — Monday through Saturday]
- [YOU SAY: the different one — “Bhānuvāra,” Sunday]
- [YOU SAY: the contrast — Hindi says Ravivāra (*Ravi*), Kannada says Bhānuvāra (*Bhānu*) — two different Sanskrit sun-names]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What ending does every Kannada weekday share, and where’s it from? (-ವಾರ -*vāra*, Sanskrit “day.”) Which day differs from Hindi’s version, and how? (**Sunday** — Kannada’s *Bhānuvāra* (“light”) uses a different Sanskrit sun-name than Hindi’s *Ravivār* (“Ravi”).)

Chapter 11

Four Core Colours

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

11.1 ಕಪ್ಪು, ಬಿಳಿ, ಕೆಂಪು, ನೀಲಿ — native colors, after a fully Sanskrit week

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Kannada’s week ran entirely on Sanskrit deity-names. Its colors tell a different story — here, native Dravidian vocabulary is back in charge, except for one familiar exception.

You’ll want to know: Three native colors

- ಕಪ್ಪು (*kappu*) = “**black**” — native Dravidian.
- ಬಿಳಿ (*bili*) = “**white**” — native Dravidian.
- ಕೆಂಪು (*kempu*) = “**red**” — native Dravidian.

You’ll want to know: The familiar borrowed blue

ನೀಲಿ (*nīli*) = “**blue**” — from the **same Sanskrit ನೀल** (*nīla*) that Tamil, Malayalam, and Hindi all reach for. Even Kannada, whose week went fully Sanskritic, still keeps its everyday black/white/red **native** — it’s specifically **blue** that pulls in the Sanskrit word, across all four Dravidian languages and Hindi alike.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “kappu, bili, kempu” — black, white, red]
- [YOU SAY: “nīli” — blue, the shared Sanskrit word]
- [YOU SAY: the contrast — Kannada’s week is Sanskritic, but its colors (except blue) are native]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Are Kannada’s black/white/red native or Sanskrit? (**Native Dravidian** — kappu, bili, kempu.) Which color is the shared Sanskrit loan across Kannada, Tamil, Malayalam, and Hindi? (**Blue** — ನೀಲಿ *nīli* / நீலம் *nīlam* / नील *nīla* / नीला *nīlā*.)

Chapter 12

Family

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

12.1 ಅಪ್ಪ, ಅಮ್ಮ, and four sibling words — the same system as Tamil

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Kannada asks the same question Tamil does about any sibling: **older, or younger?** — and the words for answering it are almost identical.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- ಅಪ್ಪ (*appa*) = “**father**” — matches Tamil *appā* closely.
- ಅಮ್ಮ (*amma*) = “**mother**” — matches Tamil *ammā* closely.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada	meaning	compare Tamil
ಅಣ್ಣ (<i>aṇṇa</i>)	older brother	<i>aṇṇan</i> — near match
ತಮ್ಮ (<i>tamma</i>)	younger brother	<i>tambi</i> — near match
ಅಕ್ಕ (<i>akka</i>)	older sister	<i>akkā</i> — near match
ತಂಗಿ (<i>tangi</i>)	younger sister	<i>tangai</i> — near match

Just like Tamil, Kannada has **no single word** that simply means “brother” or “sister” — you name the sibling’s **relative age** every time, not just their gender. This age-first system runs across the whole Dra-

vidian family, not just one language.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “appa, amma” — father, mother]
- [YOU SAY: “appa, tamma” — older/younger brother]
- [YOU SAY: “akka, tangi” — older/younger sister]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] How many Kannada sibling words are there, and what do they split on? (**Four** — ಅಣ್ಣ/ತಮ್ಮ, ಅಕ್ಕ/ತಂಗಿ — split by **relative age**, not just gender.) How closely do Kannada’s words match Tamil’s? (**Very closely** — nearly the same forms across the whole set.)

Chapter 13

Head and Hand

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

13.1 ತಲೆ, ಕೈ — head and hand, the shared Dravidian core

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Three languages, nearly one word each — Kannada’s basic body parts line up with Tamil and Malayalam almost perfectly.

You’ll want to know: The words

- ತಲೆ (*tale*) = “**head**” — native Dravidian, matching Tamil *talai* and Malayalam *thala*.
- ಕೈ (*kai*) = “**hand**” — native Dravidian, matching Tamil and Malayalam’s *kai* almost exactly.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “tale” — head]
- [YOU SAY: “kai” — hand]
- [YOU SAY: the match — nearly identical across Tamil, Malayalam, Kannada]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What are Kannada's words for head and hand? (ತಲೆ **tale**, ಕೈ **kai**.) How closely do they match Tamil and Malayalam? (**Very closely** — all three share essentially the same native Dravidian words.)

Chapter 14

Seasons

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

14.1 ವಸಂತ ಋತು, ಬೇಸಿಗೆ, ಮಳೆಗಾಲ, ಚಳಿಗಾಲ — native words, plus a double Sanskrit loan

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Kannada’s summer, rain, and cold words are native, just like Tamil’s — but its word for “spring” borrows **twice** from Sanskrit, not once.

You’ll want to know: The words

Kannada	meaning	source
ವಸಂತ ಋತು (<i>vasanta rtu</i>)	“spring”	both <i>vasanta</i> AND ಋತು <i>rtu</i> (“season”) are Sanskrit
ಬೇಸಿಗೆ (<i>bēsige</i>)	“summer”	native Dravidian
ಮಳೆಗಾಲ (<i>maḷegāla</i>)	“rainy season”	ಮಳೆ <i>maḷe</i> , native Dravidian (“rain”) + ಕಾಲ <i>kāla</i> (“time,” itself a Sanskrit loan)
ಚಳಿಗಾಲ (<i>caḷigāla</i>)	“winter/cold season”	ಚಳಿ <i>caḷi</i> , native Dravidian (“cold”) + <i>kāla</i>

Why it's said this way

Where Tamil and Malayalam just say *kaalam* (“time/season,” itself ultimately Sanskrit-derived too, but assimilated long ago as ordinary vocabulary), Kannada’s word for spring, *ವಸಂತ ಋತು*, keeps **both** halves visibly Sanskrit — *vasanta* the season-name, *ṛtu* the very word for “season.” Summer, rain, and cold, by contrast, are built on native Dravidian roots (*bēsige*, *maḷe*, *caḷi*).

And as with Tamil and Malayalam: it’s *ಮಳೆಗಾಲ* (*maḷegāla*, the rains) that shapes Karnataka’s agricultural year the most, not a clean four-way Western split.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “bēsige” — summer, native]
- [YOU SAY: “maḷegāla” — the rains]
- [YOU SAY: “caḷigāla” — the cold season, native]
- [YOU SAY: the double loan — “vasanta ṛtu” — both halves Sanskrit]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] How does *ವಸಂತ ಋತು* differ from the Tamil/Malayalam spring-word? (**Both halves are Sanskrit** — *vasanta* and *ṛtu*, “season” itself — where Tamil/Malayalam just add the long-assimilated *kaalam*.) Which season actually shapes Karnataka’s year most? (*ಮಳೆಗಾಲ*, the rains.)

Chapter 15

Water and Rice

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

15.1 ನೀರು, ಅಕ್ಕಿ, ಅನ್ನ — water matching Tamil, and rice, raw and cooked

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Kannada’s water-word sides with Tamil, not with Malayalam’s surprising break from the pack.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನೀರು (*nīru*) = “**water**” — matching Tamil’s நீர் (*nīr*, the root inside *taṇṇīr*) closely. Kannada didn’t make Malayalam’s switch to the *vel-* “bright/white” root.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- ಅಕ್ಕಿ (*akki*) = “**rice**” (raw grain).
- ಅನ್ನ (*anna*) = “**cooked rice**” (the meal) — likely Sanskrit-influenced, the same general idea as Tamil’s *sātam*.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “nīru” — water, matching Tamil]

- [YOU SAY: “akki” — raw rice]
- [YOU SAY: “anna” — cooked rice]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Does Kannada’s water-word match Tamil’s or Malayalam’s? (**Tamil’s** — *nīru/nīr*, not Malayalam’s *vellam*.) What’s the raw/cooked rice pair? (ಅಕ್ಕಿ *akki* raw, ಅನ್ನ *anna* cooked.)

Chapter 16

The Traditional Months

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

16.1 ಚೈತ್ರ to ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ — the calendar Kannada shares with Hindi, not with Tamil

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Tamil and Malayalam each built their own solar calendar. Kannada takes a different path entirely — the same path as Hindi.

You'll want to know: The twelve months

ಚೈತ್ರ, ವೈಶಾಖ, ಜ್ಯೇಷ್ಠ, ಆಷಾಢ, ಶ್ರಾವಣ, ಭಾದ್ರಪದ, ಆಶ್ವಯುಜ, ಕಾರ್ತಿಕ, ಮಾರ್ಗಶಿರ, ಪುಷ್ಯ, ಮಾಘ, ಫಾಲ್ಗುಣ (*Caitra, Vaiśākha, Jyēṣṭha, Āṣāḍha, Śrāvaṇa, Bhādrapada, Āśvayuja, Kārtika, Mārgaśira, Puṣya, Māgha, Phālguna*).

Why it's said this way

This is the **same pan-Indian Sanskritic lunisolar calendar** you already met as Hindi's **Vikram Samvat** — the same twelve month names, tied to the same **six-ṛtu** seasonal cycle. Karnataka's own New Year, **Ugadi**, falls on *Chaitra Śukla Pratipada* — the first day of the bright fortnight of Chaitra — exactly the reasoning behind Hindu New Year celebrations across much of India. Unlike Tamil's or Malayalam's genuinely home-grown solar calendars, Kannada didn't build its own separate system here — it shares this one with Hindi, Telugu, and much of the rest of the subcontinent.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: the twelve — “Caitra, Vaiśākha, Jyēṣṭha, Āṣāḍha, Śrāvaṇa, Bhādrapada, Āśvayuja, Kārtika, Mārgaśira, Puṣya, Māgha, Phālguna”]
- [YOU SAY: “Ugadi — Chaitra Śukla Pratipada”]
- [YOU SAY: the honest point — shared with Hindi, unlike Tamil/Malayalam’s own calendars]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Does Kannada use its own solar calendar, like Tamil and Malayalam? (**No** — it uses the **same pan-Indian lunisolar calendar** as Hindi’s Vikram Samvat.) What is Kannada’s New Year called, and when does it fall? (**Ugadi**, on *Chaitra Śukla Pratipada*.)

Chapter 17

Noon and Midnight

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

17.1 ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ — one Sanskrit root, two everyday Kannada words

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You’ve just seen Hindi’s *dopahar* (an old timekeeping unit) and *aadhi raat* (plain “half night”). Kannada takes a completely different path — straight to Sanskrit, and straight down the middle.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (*madhyāhna*) = “**noon, midday**” — a Sanskrit *tatsama* (borrowed whole, unchanged) compound: ಮಧ್ಯ (*madhya*, “**middle**”) + ಅಹ್ನ (*ahna*, “**day**”). This is the everyday, ordinary Kannada word for noon — not a formal or bookish alternative the way it can feel in some of its sister languages.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ (*madhyarātri*) = “**midnight**” — the exact same ಮಧ್ಯ (*madhya*, “**middle**”) root, this time compounded with ರಾತ್ರಿ (*rātri*, “**night**”). Same logic, same “middle” word, just paired with “night” instead of “day.”

Why it's said this way

Both words are unmistakably **Sanskrit tatsama** compounds — Kannada borrowed them whole rather than building native Dravidian equivalents. That's worth contrasting directly with Hindi, a language actually *descended* from Sanskrit: Hindi has these exact same words too (*madhyāhna*, *madhyarātri*), but treats them as the more **formal, literary** register — its everyday words are the homegrown *dopahar* (“two pahars”) and *aadhi raat* (“half night”) instead. Kannada, by contrast, took the Sanskrit-formal compound and made it the **plain, everyday** word — there's no separate native-Dravidian doublet in common use here the way there is for some other concepts.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “madhyāhna” — noon, “middle of the day”]
- [YOU SAY: “madhyarātri” — midnight, “middle of the night”]
- [YOU SAY: the shared piece — “madhya,” middle, in both words]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What Sanskrit root do ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ and ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ share, and what does it mean? (ಮಧ್ಯ, *madhya*, “middle.”) Are these native Dravidian words or Sanskrit borrowings? (**Sanskrit tatsama** borrowings, taken whole.) Does Hindi treat its version of these words as everyday or formal? (**Formal/literary** — Hindi's everyday words are *dopahar* and *aadhi raat* instead.)

Chapter 18

Telling Time

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

18.1 ಗಂಟೆ — the same “bell” word as Hindi, borrowed through Prakrit

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You’ve already met Hindi’s *ghaṇṭā* — “hour,” literally “bell.” Kannada has the exact same word, arriving by the exact same logic.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಗಂಟೆ (*gaṇṭe*) = “**hour**” — and, just like Hindi, it means “**bell, gong**” just as commonly. It’s related to the same Sanskrit घण्टा (*ghaṇṭā*, “bell”). The semantic shift is identical to Hindi’s: temples, towns, and clock towers announced the hour by striking a bell, so the bell-word became the hour-word.

Why it’s said this way

This is a genuinely different picture from what you’ll see in Tamil. Kannada’s *gaṇṭe*, like Hindi’s *ghaṇṭā*, is a **Sanskrit-derived** “bell → hour” word. Tamil, by contrast, most likely uses a **native Dravidian** word for exactly the same “bell → hour” idea — a different root entirely, arrived at independently (though even specialists don’t call this fully settled). So the *pattern* (bell-word becomes hour-word) repeats across languages, but the *word itself* splits along the same Sanskrit/native line you’ve seen

before in this course (compare *madhyāhna* vs. Tamil’s *naḷ*-based words for noon).

Grammar Lens: telling the time

ಒಂದು ಗಂಟೆ. — “One o’clock.” (*ondu gaṇṭe*, “one hour/bell”)

ಎರಡು ಗಂಟೆ. — “Two o’clock.” (*eraḍu gaṇṭe*)

Kannada simply pairs the cardinal number with *gaṇṭe* — no ordinal/cardinal split like Arabic’s, no singular/plural verb switch like Hindi’s *baṇā*.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “gaṇṭe” — hour, also “bell”]
- [YOU SAY: “ondu gaṇṭe” — one o’clock]
- [YOU SAY: “eraḍu gaṇṭe” — two o’clock]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What does ಗಂಟೆ mean besides “hour,” and what Sanskrit word is it related to? (“**Bell, gong**” — related to Sanskrit *ghaṇṭā*.) Is this the same root Hindi uses for “hour”? (**Yes** — Hindi’s *ghaṇṭā* is the same Sanskrit word.) Does Tamil use this same Sanskrit root for “hour”? (**Most likely not** — it uses a native Dravidian word instead, arrived at independently.)

Chapter 19

Asking Someone's Age

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

19.1 ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು? — “your age, how much?”

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Here's a genuinely nice callback: the Sanskrit word behind Kannada's “age” is a distant cousin of a Latin word you already know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ವಯಸ್ಸು (*vayassu*, “age”) comes from Sanskrit वयस् (*vayas*, “age, youth, vigor, strength”), which traces back to **Proto-Indo-European** *wéy_h₁os*. That PIE root is the **same** one behind Latin *vīs*, “force, strength, vigor” — so Sanskrit's word for “age” and Latin's word for “force” are genuine, distant cousins, both carrying the older sense of “vigor, life-force” before splitting toward different specific meanings.

Grammar Lens: a simple possessive, no verb

ನಿನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಎಷ್ಟು? — “How old are you?” — literally “**your** age — **how much?**” (*ninna vayassu eṣṭu?*)

ನನ್ನ ವಯಸ್ಸು ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು. — “I am twenty years old.” — literally “**my** age [is] **twenty.**” (*nanna vayassu ippattu.*)

Just like Arabic's *ʿumr*, this is a **verbless** construction in the present tense — Kannada simply states “your age” and “how much,” with no

“is” needed. But notice the shape is simpler than Arabic’s: no possessive suffix fused onto the noun, just the ordinary possessive word ನಿನ್ನ (*ninna*, “your”) sitting in front of ವಯಸ್ಸು.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “vayassu” — age]
- [YOU SAY: “ninna vayassu eṣṭu?” — how old are you?]
- [YOU SAY: “nanna vayassu ippattu” — I am twenty, “my age [is] twenty”]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What Sanskrit word is ವಯಸ್ಸು from, and what Latin word is its PIE cousin? (वयस्, *vayas*, “age/vigor” — cousin of Latin *vīs*, “force,” both from PIE *wéyh₁os*.) Does Kannada use a verb to state age? (**No** — “your age how-much,” no verb needed.) How do you say “I am twenty”? (Nanna vayassu ippattu — “my age [is] twenty.”)

Chapter 20

Numbers 11–20 and Weather

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

20.1 ಹನ್ನೊಂದು to ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು — numbers 11–20

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You’ve now seen four different language families each build “twenty” as its own special, opaque word — Sanskrit’s *vimshati*, Latin’s *viginti*, Arabic’s *‘ishrūn*. Kannada’s twenty genuinely started life as “two tens” too — but be careful: the modern surface no longer shows it plainly.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada’s teens are built on ಹತ್ತು (*hattu*, “ten”) plus each digit — ಹನ್ನೊಂದು (*hannondū*, 11), ಹನ್ನೆರಡು (*hanneradu*, 12), and onward through ಹತ್ತೊಂಬತ್ತು (*hattombattu*, 19). Each teen is a compound built the same way English builds “four-teen” — just placed the same digit-plus-ten pattern in front instead of behind.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು (*ippattu*, “twenty”) traces back to Proto-Dravidian ***ir-** (“two”) + ***paHtu** (“ten”) — a genuine compositional origin, “two-tens.” But be honest about what’s actually visible today: the ***ir-** piece is an old *bound* root, not the same as modern Kannada’s everyday word for “two,” ಎರಡು (*eradu*) — a separate, longer descendant of the same ancient family. And the “ten” piece surfaces here as **-pp-** (geminated after the

r), not as modern ಹತ್ತು (*hattu*)’s **h-** — because Kannada’s historical *p* → *h* shift only fired at the **start** of a word, and this “ten” sits in the **middle** of the compound, so it never lenited. So *ippattu* really did start as “two-tens” — you just can’t spot modern *eraḍu* or modern *hattu* inside it anymore the way you might expect. Compare this to Sanskrit’s विंशति (*vimshati*), Latin’s *vīgintī*, and Arabic’s عشرون (*‘ishrūn*): those have **no** compositional “two-ten” origin at all, not even a buried one — a genuinely different kind of history from Kannada’s.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “hannondu, hannerāḍu” — 11, 12]
- [YOU SAY: “hattu” — ten (today’s word), “eraḍu” — two (today’s word)]
- [YOU SAY: “ippattu” — twenty, “two-tens” underneath, from the OLD *ir-*/ *paHtu* roots, not directly from *hattu*/*eraḍu*]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] How are Kannada’s teens built? (ಹತ್ತು (ten) + a digit, compounded.) Does ಇಪ್ಪತ್ತು (twenty) have a compositional “two-tens” origin? (**Yes** — Proto-Dravidian **ir-* “two” + **paHtu* “ten.”) Can you still spot modern *eraḍu* or modern *hattu* inside it today? (**No** — the old bound “two” root and the un-lenited middle-of-word “ten” root look different from their modern standalone descendants.) Do Sanskrit’s *vimshati* or Latin’s *vīgintī* have any compositional origin like this at all? (**No** — neither has a buried “two-ten” history the way Kannada’s does.)

20.2 ಹವಾಮಾನ — a genuine two-language hybrid word

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Kannada’s word for “weather” isn’t purely Sanskrit or purely native — it’s a compound with a piece from each of two different borrowed sources.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹವಾಮಾನ (*havāmāna*) = “**weather**” — built from two pieces:

- ಹವಾ (*hava*, “**air**”) — itself a loanword, from **Persian** هوا (*havā*), which traces back to **Arabic** هَوَاً (*hawāʾ*, “air”). This is the exact same root behind Hindi’s own हवा (*havā*, “air, wind”).
- ಮಾನ (*māna*, “**measure**”) — from **Sanskrit** मान (*māna*), “measure, standard” (the same word behind *pramāṇa*, “proof, measure of truth”).

So *havāmāna* literally means “**air-measure**” — and it’s genuinely a two-source hybrid, not a single borrowed compound: one piece Perso-Arabic, one piece Sanskrit, fused into one Kannada word.

You’ll want to know: ಮಳೆ ಬರುತ್ತಿದೆ — “rain is coming”

ಮಳೆ ಬರುತ್ತಿದೆ. — “It’s raining.” — literally “**rain is coming**.”
(*maḷe baruttide*.)

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “havāmāna” — weather, literally “air-measure”]
- [YOU SAY: “hava” — air, a Persian/Arabic loan]
- [YOU SAY: “maḷe baruttide” — it’s raining, “rain is coming”]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What are the two pieces of ಹವಾಮಾನ, and where does each come from? (ಹವಾ, “air,” a **Persian/Arabic** loan; ಮಾನ, “measure,” native **Sanskrit**.) What does *havāmāna* literally mean? (“**Air-measure**.”) What other Indian language shares the exact same word for “air”? (**Hindi** — *havā*.)

Chapter 21

Dog and Cat

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

21.1 ನಾಯಿ, ಬೆಕ್ಕು — solid ground, and a genuine split

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] After a whole arc of mystery dog-words — Spanish’s *perro*, English’s *dog*, Hindi’s *kuttā* — here’s the opposite: a dog-word with absolutely no mystery attached.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ನಾಯಿ (*nāyi*, “**dog**”) is a genuine, native **Proto-Dravidian** root — no debate, no substrate mystery, nothing like the *perro/dog/kuttā* pattern you’ve now seen across three unrelated language families. It’s the same root shared right across the Dravidian family.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಬೆಕ್ಕು (*bekku*, “**cat**”) is where things get honestly more complicated. It’s cognate with a **different** ancient Dravidian root — the same one behind Tamil and Malayalam’s word for “**wildcat**” or “**civet cat**” — not the same root as Tamil’s **everyday** word for cat. So unlike “dog,” where Dravidian largely agrees on one shared root, “cat” genuinely **splits**: different Dravidian languages settled on different ancient roots for their everyday word.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “nāyi” — dog, solid native Dravidian, no mystery]
- [YOU SAY: “bekku” — cat, a different Dravidian root than Tamil’s everyday word]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Is நாயி a mystery word, like Spanish’s *perro* or Hindi’s *kuttā*? (**No** — a solid, native Proto-Dravidian root.) Does ಬೆಕ್ಕು come from the same root as Tamil’s everyday cat-word? (**No** — a genuinely different ancient Dravidian root, related instead to the word for “wildcat.”)

Chapter 22

Green and Yellow

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

22.1 ಹಸಿರು, ಹಳದಿ — a real Dravidian family, and a borrowed cousin of gelb

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Kannada’s green word belongs to a real Dravidian family you’ll meet again soon. Its yellow word isn’t native at all — and it turns out to be hiding the very same ancient root this whole arc keeps circling back to.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹಸಿರು (*hasiru*, “green”) comes from Old Kannada ಪಸಿರ್ (*pasir*), from **Proto-Dravidian** **pac-*, “green” — the **exact same root** behind Tamil’s பச்சை (*paccai*) and Telugu’s పచ్చ (*pacca*). Kannada even keeps a doublet of its own, ಪಚ್ಚಿ (*pacce*), sitting right alongside *hasiru*. So unlike Kannada’s blue (ನೀಲಿ, borrowed from Sanskrit), green here is the real, deep, native Dravidian word — and this particular root will keep resurfacing as Telugu, Malayalam, and Tamil’s own green words come up later in this same arc.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಹಳದಿ (*haḷadi*, “yellow”) is **not** Kannada’s native turmeric word — that’s ಅರಿಶಿನ (*ariśina*). Instead, *haḷadi* appears to be shaped by Sanskrit/Hindi हरिद्रा/हल्दी (*haridrā/haldi*, “turmeric”), the same word

that gives “turmeric” across a huge swath of Indo-Aryan languages (Hindi/Urdu/Punjabi *haldi*, Bengali *holud*, Odia *haladi*) — and in some of these, like Bengali and Odia, that turmeric-word doubles as the everyday word for the color **yellow** itself, exactly as *haḷadi* does in Kannada (Hindi keeps the two separate: *haldi* stays “turmeric,” while “yellow” is the unrelated word *pīlā*). Here’s the part that closes a loop running through this whole arc: **haridrā** itself traces back to हरि (*hari*, “yellow, tawny”), from **Proto-Indo-European** **ǵʰelh₃-* — the **same ancient root** already behind Hindi’s own हरा (*harā*, “green”) and German’s *gelb* (“yellow”). So Kannada picked up its yellow word from a completely different language family, Indo-Aryan rather than Dravidian — and that borrowed word still lands on the exact same PIE root this arc has been tracing all along.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “ಹಸಿರು” — green, a real Dravidian cousin of Tamil *paccai* and Telugu *pacca*]
- [YOU SAY: “ಹಳದಿ” — yellow, borrowed, and secretly a cousin of *gelb*]
- [YOU SAY: the contrast — *hasiru* is native Dravidian; *haladi* is a Sanskrit/ Hindi loan built on the turmeric word]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What Proto-Dravidian root gives ಹಸಿರು (*hasiru*), and which two other Dravidian languages share it? (**pac-*, “green” — shared with **Tamil’s** *paccai* and **Telugu’s** *pacca*.) Is ಹಳದಿ (*haḷadi*) Kannada’s native word for turmeric? (**No** — that’s *ariśina*; *haḷadi* is a Sanskrit/Hindi loan.) What ancient PIE root connects **haḷadi**, through Sanskrit **hari**, to Hindi’s **harā** and German’s **gelb**? (**ǵʰelh₃-*, “to shine.”)

Chapter 23

Day

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

23.1 ದಿನ (dina) — “day,” Sanskrit kept whole

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You’ve already met Sanskrit’s “middle” compounds for noon and midnight. Here’s the plain word for “day” itself — and a genuinely interesting twist on how borrowing works.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ದಿನ (dina) — “day” — is a Sanskrit **tatsama** word: borrowed **whole**, unchanged, the same way *madhyāhna*/*madhyarātri* were (Chapter 17). It’s Kannada’s ordinary, everyday word for “a day.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here’s the honest twist: Kannada’s *dina* and Hindi’s दिन (*din*) trace to the **exact same** Sanskrit word, दिन (*dina*) — but they got there by **different routes**. Hindi’s *din* is a **tadbhava** form: Sanskrit *dina* wore down naturally over centuries, through Prakrit, losing its final vowel along the way. Kannada’s *dina*, by contrast, is a direct **tatsama** borrowing — taken straight from Sanskrit, unworn, keeping the full shape. So Kannada’s *dina* and Hindi’s *din* look almost identical, but one is an unbroken **inheritance** (eroded), the other a **later borrowing** (kept whole) — genuinely different histories landing on nearly the same

modern word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada does have a genuine **native Dravidian** word here too: ಹಗಲು (*hagalu*) — but be careful, it means specifically “**daytime**” (the daylight hours, as opposed to night), not “**a day**” as a calendar unit. It’s not a synonym for *dina*; it’s a different sense of “day” entirely.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “dina” — “day,” Sanskrit tatsama, kept whole]
- [YOU SAY: the twist — dina and Hindi’s din, same Sanskrit source, but borrowing vs. natural erosion]
- [YOU SAY: hagalu — native Dravidian, “daytime,” a different sense than dina]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Is Kannada’s ದಿನ a tatsama borrowing or a tadbhava inheritance? (**Tatsama** — borrowed whole from Sanskrit.) How does this differ from Hindi’s दिन (*din*), even though both trace to the same Sanskrit word? (**Din is tadbhava** — naturally eroded through Prakrit — while Kannada’s *dina* was borrowed later, unworn.) What does ಹಗಲು (*hagalu*) mean, and is it a synonym for *dina*? (“**Daytime**” — a different sense, not “a day” as a calendar unit.)

Chapter 24

Night

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

24.1 ರಾತ್ರಿ (rātri) — “night,” and its native cousin, pushed aside

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Last lesson’s *dina* had a living native partner, *hagalu*. This word’s native partner tells a different, more honest story — one of being pushed out, not living alongside.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ರಾತ್ರಿ (rātri) — “night” — is the same Sanskrit **tatsama** word already hiding inside ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ (*madhyarātri*, “midnight,” Chapter 17), now standing on its own as Kannada’s ordinary, everyday word for “night.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Kannada **does** have a genuine **native Dravidian** word for night: ಇರುಳು (*iruḷu*), from **Proto-Dravidian** **cirVl* — a real pan-Dravidian cognate, matching **Tamil**’s இருள் (*irul*), **Malayalam**’s ഇരുൾ (*irul*), and **Telugu**’s ఇరులు (*irulu*). But here’s the honest difference from last lesson’s *hagalu*: while *hagalu* is still a **living, everyday** word (just for a different sense, “daytime”), *iruḷu* has been genuinely **pushed aside** by the Sanskrit loan — it now survives mainly in **older poetry**, carrying extra metaphorical weight (“darkness,” even “ignorance”), rather than in everyday speech. *Rātri* simply **won** the job of “night” in modern

Kannada.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “rātri” — “night,” already met inside madhyarātri]
- [YOU SAY: “irulu” — the real native word, now mostly archaic/poetic]
- [YOU SAY: the honest contrast — hagalu still lives (different sense); irulu was pushed aside (same sense, lost the job)]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Where have you already met ರಾತ್ರಿ before this lesson? (ಮಧ್ಯರಾತ್ರಿ, *madhyarātri*, “midnight.”) What genuine native Dravidian word for “night” does Kannada have, and what’s its status today? (ಇರುಳು, *irulu* — largely **archaic**, surviving mainly in older poetry.) How is *irulu*’s story different from *hagalu*’s, from last lesson? (**Hagalu still lives**, for a different sense [“daytime”]; **irulu was pushed aside** entirely by the Sanskrit loan, for the same sense [“night”].)

Chapter 25

Good Night

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

25.1 ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ (śubha rātri) — “good night,” auspicious to the end

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You already have *rātri*. Pair it with one more Sanskrit word, and you have Kannada’s everyday “good night” — the same phrase, word for word, as Hindi’s.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ (śubha rātri) — “good night” — literally “**auspicious night**.” Both pieces are Sanskrit **tatsama**: ರಾತ್ರಿ (*rātri*, “night,” already met last lesson) plus ಶುಭ (śubha, “**auspicious, good**”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭ (śubha) comes from the Sanskrit verbal root śubh, whose core sense is “**to be beautiful, splendid**” — traceable to a well-sourced **Proto-Indo-European** root, **kewb^h*- (“to be beautiful”). A further, more speculative connection to a root meaning “to shine” has also been proposed — but either way, the underlying idea is a familiar one: **auspiciousness imagined as a kind of radiance or beauty**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here’s the honest cross-language note: ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ and Hindi’s own शुभ रात्रि are, word for word, the **exact same phrase** — a Dravidian language and an Indo-Aryan language landing on an identical “good night.” The most likely explanation is **shared Sanskrit vocabulary**, not one language directly copying the phrase from the other — but be honest about the limits of that claim: “good night” as a farewell greeting is itself a **modern** convention across Indian languages, not an ancient one, so some degree of cross-language reinforcement (Hindi’s wide reach as a pan-Indian media language, for instance) can’t be ruled out either. Unlike Hindi, where *rātri* is the formal member of a live doublet against everyday *raat*, Kannada’s *rātri* is simply the ordinary word (Chapter 24) — so this phrase draws on shared **Sanskrit vocabulary**, not a shared “formal-versus-everyday” register split the way it does in Hindi.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “śubha rātri” — “good night,” literally “auspicious night”]
- [YOU SAY: śubha’s own root — śubh, “to be beautiful” → “auspicious”]
- [YOU SAY: the honest cross-language note — identical to Hindi’s shubh rātri, most likely via shared Sanskrit vocabulary, though direct reinforcement can’t be fully ruled out]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What does ಶುಭ ರಾತ್ರಿ literally mean? (“**Auspicious night.**”) What does ಶುಭ literally trace back to? (A root meaning “**to be beautiful, splendid.**”) Is Kannada’s *śubha rātri* definitely borrowed directly from Hindi? (**Most likely not** — shared Sanskrit vocabulary is the more parsimonious explanation, though since “good night” as a farewell is itself a modern convention, some cross-language reinforcement can’t be fully ruled out.)

Chapter 26

Morning

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

26.1 ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (beḷagge) — the one time-word that’s genuinely Kannada’s own

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Every everyday time-word you’ve met in Kannada so far — day, night, noon, midnight — has been Sanskrit, borrowed whole. This one breaks that pattern completely.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (beḷagge) — “morning” — is **native Dravidian**, built on ಬೆಳಗು (*beḷagu*, “to shine, to become bright, to dawn”) and the related noun ಬೆಳಕು (*beḷaku*, “light”). Morning is, quite literally, “the shining,” “the dawning” — a transparent, homegrown metaphor, no borrowed vocabulary anywhere in it.

Why it’s said this way

Here’s what makes this lesson different from every other Kannada time-word lesson so far: ದಿನ (*dina*, “day”), ರಾತ್ರಿ (*raṭri*, “night”), and ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (*madhyāhna*, “noon”) are all genuine **Sanskrit tatsama** borrowings, taken whole, doing the plain everyday job in Kannada. ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ breaks that streak — it’s the one everyday time-word in this set that’s actually **Kannada’s own**, not a loan from anywhere. If you’d only met *dina*,

ratri, and *madhyāhna*, you might start to assume every Kannada time-word is Sanskrit underneath. This one is the honest counter-example — though, matching the pattern already seen with *hagalu* and *irulu* (Chapters 23–24), a native compound for “noon” does technically exist too: **ನಡುಹಗಲು** (*naḍuhagalu*, “middle-of-daytime,” built from *naḍu*, “middle,” the same everyday word already met, plus *hagalu*). It just lost the everyday job to *madhyāhna*, the same way *hagalu* and *irulu* were pushed into narrower, or archaic, roles by their own Sanskrit competitors.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “beḷagge” — “morning,” native Dravidian]
- [YOU SAY: the root — beḷagu, “to shine, to dawn,” and beḷaku, “light”]
- [YOU SAY: the contrast — dina, ratri, madhyāhna are all Sanskrit; beḷagge is genuinely Kannada’s own]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What native root does ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ come from, and what does it mean? (ಬೆಳಗು/ಬೆಳಕು — “to shine/dawn” and “light.”) Is ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ a Sanskrit tatsama, like dina, ratri, and madhyāhna? (**No** — genuinely native Dravidian, the odd one out among Kannada’s everyday time-words.)

Chapter 27

Evening

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

27.1 ಸಂಜೆ (sañje) — a Sanskrit word that arrived already worn down

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] ದಿನ, ರಾತ್ರಿ, and ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ all arrived in Kannada whole, unworn, straight from Sanskrit. This word took a very different route — and it lands somewhere genuinely surprising.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಸಂಜೆ (sañje) — “evening” — traces to **Sanskrit** ಸಂಧ್ಯಾ (*saṃdhyā*, “twilight,” literally “the junction of day and night”) — but it didn’t arrive in Kannada as a fresh, whole tatsama the way *dina*, *ratri*, and *madhyāhna* did. Instead, it came by way of **Maharashtri Prakrit** ಸಂಯಾ (*sañjhā*) — Sanskrit’s word, already worn down by centuries of everyday Middle Indo-Aryan speech, *then* borrowed into Kannada in that already-eroded shape.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here’s the genuinely surprising part: Hindi’s own evening word, साँझ (*sañjh*), comes from the **exact same** Sanskrit ಸಂಧ್ಯಾ — but by a **different** route. Hindi *inherited* it, generation to generation, through **Śauraseni Prakrit** (a different, sister Middle Indo-Aryan dialect than

the Maharashtri Prakrit Kannada borrowed from). Two separate erosion paths — one an unbroken inheritance within the Indo-Aryan family, one a loan crossing into a completely different language family — and they land on nearly **identical-sounding** modern words, *sañje* and *sāñjh*, purely because they share the same Sanskrit starting point.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “sañje” — “evening,” from Sanskrit *sandhyā* via Maharashtri Prakrit]
- [YOU SAY: the contrast with *dina*/*ratri*/*madhyāhna* — those arrived whole; *sañje* arrived already worn down]
- [YOU SAY: the striking convergence — Hindi’s साँझ, same Sanskrit root, different Prakrit path, nearly the same sound today]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Does ಸಂಜೆ arrive in Kannada as a fresh, whole Sanskrit tatsama, like *dina* and *ratri* did? (**No** — it arrived already worn down, via Maharashtri Prakrit ಸಂಧ್ಯಾ.) What Hindi word shares ಸಂಜೆ’s exact Sanskrit root, and by what different path did it get there? (साँझ (*sāñjh*) — inherited via a different sister Prakrit, Śauraseni, rather than borrowed via Maharashtri.)

Chapter 28

Afternoon

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

28.1 ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (aparāhna) — the same “-ahna” pattern, a different first piece

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You already know ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, “noon” — “middle” plus “day.” This lesson’s word for “afternoon” uses the exact same building pattern, just with a different first piece.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (aparāhna) — “afternoon” — is a genuine **Sanskrit tatsama**: ಅಪರ (apara, “latter, further”) + the same -ಅಹ್ನ (-ahna, “day”) suffix already hiding inside ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (madhyāhna, “noon,” Chapter 17). Same clean two-piece structure, same “day” ending — just swap *madhya* (“middle”) for *apara* (“latter, further along”) and you move from “noon” to “afternoon.” This distinction comes from a genuine, classical **five-part Sanskrit division of the day** — *prāta* (early morning), *saṅgava*, *madhyāhna* (noon), *aparāhna* (afternoon), *sāyāhna* (evening) — with *aparāhna* landing specifically as the fourth part, after noon and before evening.

Why it’s said this way

Here’s where this lesson needs real care: some sources describe ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ itself being stretched loosely in casual modern speech to cover the whole

afternoon too — which would echo Hindi’s own दोपहर, already found in this course to have genuinely widened from “precisely noon” to “the whole afternoon.” But the evidence for Kannada is **much thinner** than what backed the Hindi finding — general dictionary listings rather than clear, independently-confirmed usage sources. Treat this as a plausible, hedged parallel, not a settled fact the way दोपहर’s widening was. ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ remains the more precisely, formally correct word for “afternoon” specifically.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “aparāhna” — “afternoon,” apara + ahna]
- [YOU SAY: the shared piece with madhyāhna — both end in “-ahna,” “day”]
- [YOU SAY: the honest hedge — madhyāhna MAY also loosely cover “afternoon” in casual speech, but this is far less certain than Hindi’s dopahar-widening story]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] What suffix does ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ share with ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, and what does it mean? (-ಅಹ್ನ, -ahna, “day.”) What’s the difference in their first pieces? (ಅಪರ, *apara*, “latter/further” vs. ಮಧ್ಯ, *madhya*, “middle.”) Is the claim that ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ also covers “afternoon” in casual speech as well-supported as Hindi’s दोपहर-widening finding? (**No** — much more thinly sourced; treat it as a hedged possibility, not a settled fact.)

Chapter 29

Good Morning

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

29.1 ಶುಭೋದಯ (śubhōdaya) — “good morning,” a third root for morning

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You already have ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ, the everyday word for “morning.” This greeting reaches for a completely different word for the same idea — and, honestly, this lesson’s twist is about how uncertain its own “everyday” status turns out to be, once you look closely.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭೋದಯ (śubhōdaya) — “good morning” — is built from ಶುಭ (śubha, “good, auspicious”) plus ಉದಯ (udaya, “rising, sunrise,” from Sanskrit ud- “up” + i “to go” — the same root behind ಸೂರ್ಯೋದಯ, sūryōdaya, “sunrise” itself). This is a **completely different word** from ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ (beḷagge, Chapter 26’s native “morning”) — Kannada now has (at least) two unrelated roots circling the idea of morning: one native (“the shining”), one Sanskrit (“the rising”).

Why it’s said this way

Here’s where this lesson needs real care. Some sources describe ಶುಭೋದಯ as the most common everyday way to say “good morning” in Kannada — but these are largely the same genre of generic phrasebook

site whose claims about Hindi’s सुप्रभात turned out, on closer inspection, to be overstated. A more careful source instead describes ಶುಭೋದಯ as reserved mainly for **formal or written** contexts — speeches, greeting cards, WhatsApp images — calling it “not as frequently used in daily conversations” as ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ/ನಮಸ್ತೆ, and at least one native-speaker account suggests casual spoken Kannada often reaches for **English** “good morning” instead of ಶುಭೋದಯ entirely. Taken together, this looks like the **same** formal/written skew already found for Hindi’s सुप्रभात, not the genuine cross-language contrast a first pass at the sources might suggest. A native alternate, ಶುಭ ಮುಂಜಾನೆ (*śubha muñjāne*, using *muñjāne*, “the early morning, before sunrise”), also exists as a real, attested greeting construction — but its own register isn’t independently confirmed here either.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “śubhōdaya” — “good morning,” śubha + udaya]
- [YOU SAY: the root contrast — beḷagge is native “shining”; udaya is Sanskrit “rising”]
- [YOU SAY: the honest note — sources conflict, but the more careful ones point to the same formal/written skew already found for Hindi]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Does ಶುಭೋದಯ share a root with ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ? (No — ಉದಯ, “rising,” is a completely different Sanskrit root from native ಬೆಳಗ್ಗೆ’s “shining.”) Is ಶುಭೋದಯ genuinely common in everyday casual Kannada speech? (**Unclear, and possibly not** — sources conflict; the more careful ones describe it skewing formal/written, with ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ/ನಮಸ್ತೆ covering casual mornings instead, and one native-speaker account suggests English “good morning” often gets used in casual speech instead of ಶುಭೋದಯ entirely.)

Chapter 30

Good Evening

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

30.1 ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ (śubha sañje) — formal, and correctly citing where ಸಂಜೆ comes from

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] You already have ಸಂಜೆ, “evening” — and you already know it’s a Sanskrit word that arrived in Kannada already worn down, via Prakrit. Keep that fact straight here, since it’s an easy one to second-guess.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ (śubha sañje) — “good evening” — pairs ಶುಭ (“good, auspicious”) with ಸಂಜೆ, the exact word from Chapter 27: Sanskrit ಸಂಧ್ಯಾ (saṃdhyā), borrowed into Kannada via **Maharashtri Prakrit** ಸಂಝಾ (sañjhā). You might run across a plausible-sounding claim elsewhere that ಸಂಜೆ is “native Dravidian” — it isn’t, and you already have the real answer from Chapter 27. Don’t let a claim that merely *sounds* plausible override something you’ve already verified.

Why it’s said this way

Here’s where this lesson needs to be careful about its own sourcing, not just the etymology’s. General impressions lean toward ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ skewing **formal**, with the all-purpose ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ — or, among younger urban speakers, borrowed English “**hello**” — more likely to cover ordinary ca-

sual conversation. But the evidence for this specific register claim is genuinely **thin**: it's the same kind of impression that, for both Hindi's सुप्रभात and Kannada's own ಶುಭೋದಯ, needed real digging to confirm or correct, and here that deeper digging hasn't turned up anything more solid than a general leaning. Treat this as an open **question**, echoing the same one already raised for those two greetings, not a third confirmed data point — this lesson doesn't have strong enough sourcing to settle it either way.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “śubha sañje” — “good evening,” a genuinely Sanskrit-rooted pairing]
- [YOU SAY: the correction — ಸಂಜೆ is Sanskrit-via-Prakrit, NOT native Dravidian, whatever a plausible-sounding claim elsewhere might say]
- [YOU SAY: ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ — the likely all-purpose everyday alternative, though this greeting's own register remains an open question]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Is ಸಂಜೆ native Dravidian? (**No** — Sanskrit ಸಂಧ್ಯಾ via Maharashtri Prakrit, already established in Chapter 27; be skeptical of any claim otherwise.) Is it settled that ಶುಭ ಸಂಜೆ is formal/rare in casual speech, the way सुप्रभात and ಶುಭೋದಯ turned out to be? (**Not settled** — the impression leans that way, with ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ likely covering casual use, but the sourcing here is too thin to call it confirmed.)

Chapter 31

Good Afternoon

This chapter is generated from the canonical micro-lessons used by Language Ladder. Each section stays independently resumable and preserves the authored prerequisite order.

31.1 ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ — good afternoon

Warm-up. [PAUSE 2s] Two lessons ago you met a careful hedge: does ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ, “noon,” also loosely cover “afternoon”? This greeting hands you a real data point.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (*śubha madhyāhna*) — “good afternoon” — is the standard greeting for this concept. Notice which noun it actually reuses: ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (*madhyāhna*, “noon,” Chapter 17) — **not** ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (*aparāhna*, the word Chapter 28 established as the more precisely “afternoon”-specific term). This is exactly the kind of concrete usage evidence that bears on Chapter 28’s own hedge: if the standard **greeting** for “good afternoon” reaches for *madhyāhna* rather than *aparāhna*, that’s a real (if still not fully conclusive) sign that *madhyāhna*’s job has genuinely stretched to cover the afternoon in everyday use, not just at noon itself.

Why it’s said this way

Here’s the useful discipline this lesson followed: checking a claim against an actual, directly fetched source page, not just trusting a search-engine’s own summary of one. That check turned up **two** claims of very different strength. ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ’s status as a genuinely **universal** greeting

— suited to any time of day, any occasion — is independently confirmed across multiple fetched sources; that one’s solid. The claim that ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ leans **formal or semi-formal** — workplaces, official meetings — traces back to just **one** source. It’s a real, directly-verified data point, worth taking seriously — but it isn’t cross-corroborated the way the ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ claim is, so treat it as a single well-checked impression, not a settled fact.

Guided Practice

[PAUSE 1s]

- [YOU SAY: “śubha madhyāhna” — “good afternoon,” reusing the “noon” word, not “aparāhna”]
- [YOU SAY: why that matters — real evidence for madhyāhna’s meaning stretching to cover “afternoon”]
- [YOU SAY: ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ — the confirmed universal, any-time-of-day greeting, cross-checked across multiple sources]

Wrap-up recall

[PAUSE 3s] Does ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ use ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ (“noon”) or ಅಪರಾಹ್ನ (the more precise “afternoon” word)? (ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ — real evidence for its meaning stretching to cover “afternoon” too.) Is the “formal/workplace” register claim for ಶುಭ ಮಧ್ಯಾಹ್ನ as solidly confirmed as ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ’s universal status? (**No** — the workplace claim rests on a single directly-verified source, not cross-corroborated the way ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ’s is.) What’s the confirmed universal, any-time-of-day alternative? (ನಮಸ್ಕಾರ.)